New Dundee Public School - School Council Agenda/Minutes

Date: November 25th, 2024
Time: 7:00 p.m. – 8:20 p.m.

Meeting Link:
School Council Handbook: School Council Handbook

---

1. Introductions and Attendance

- **Principal:** Craig Bell
- **Staff:** Paula Wilson, Kelly Willig
- **Chair:** Angie Hallman
- **Co-Chair:** Sarah Cherry
- **Secretary:** Melissa Kristensen
- **Treasurer:** Sarah Benn

- **School Council:**Keizo Marui, Stephanie Breitkopf
- **Student:** none
- **Regrets:** Rob Entz, Carolyn Winsborough, Melissa Battler, Tanya Eby

---

2. Welcome / Territory Acknowledgment

As we gather virtually this evening, we would like to honor the existence of the First Peoples by acknowledging that we are on the traditional land of the Anishinaabe, Haudenosaunee, and Mississauga peoples. New Dundee Public School occupies the land of the Between the Lakes Treaty from 1792. As learners, we continue to understand this place has significance to the First Peoples because of the rolling hills, forests, flat land, and the proximity to the Nith and Grand River, which is fed by the Great Lakes. Settlers need to take responsibility to continue our education and honor of the First Peoples. Let's work to honor the Dish with One Spoon covenant, a peace agreement made between the Indigenous nations before the settlers arrived. It characterizes our collective responsibility to each other and to Mother Earth. We should only take what we need and leave enough for future generations.

---

1. **Drills, Safety etc.**

   Old fire alarm sensors have been going off when there is no fire and students have been practicing fire drills because of it. The sensors are being fixed.

- **Action Items:**

---

2. Principal's Report

- Incorporated into the sections below.
- **Action Items:**

---

3. Staffing Update

- None discussed.
- **Action Items:**

---

4. Clubs

- **Clubs/groups**: none discussed.

- **Assemblies:** Remembrance Day assembly November 11th
- THANK-YOU to Mr. McKenzie's Grade 5/6 class along with the assistance of Ms. Barrow, Mr. Grundy and Ms. Ferreira who worked with other classes on songs, poems and artwork.

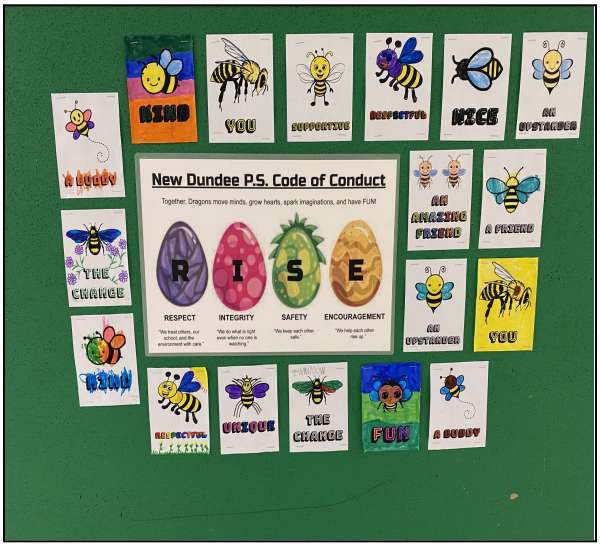
- **Action Items:**

---

5. Events, Field Trips & Initiatives

- ***Bullying Awareness & Prevention Week*** - November 18-26 - Whole School "**BEE KIND**" theme including bulletin boards, activities, announcements and read alouds.

- 

- 

- 

- Posters will be left up year round

- **Field Trips:** November 14th - Grade 4/5 & 5/6 classes saw the play: Matilda
- **Clubs & Connections**:
- -Butterfly Club - Grade 3/4 (Ms. Wilson's class) - determining location of waystation
- -Kodaly (singing) has started (Ms. Wilson & Mr. Grundy)
    - Board initiative, songs are pre-determined, only for grades 4 - 6
    - Centre in the Square performance on May 6 & 7 to sing with other schools
- -Grade 1/2 STEM - November (Ms. De Naeyer & Ms. McGill)
    - Monthly visits from an University of Waterloo Engineer
- -Grade 1/2 Pen pals with Seniors from Community Care Concepts of Woolwich, Wellesley and Wilmot (Ms. De Naeyer)
- -Many classes have registered for ESQube - STEM presentations from representatives at the University of Waterloo (Spring 2025, mid/end April)

- **Events: Coming up in December!!**
- **- *Winter Concert*** - Thursday, December 12th @ 12:30 & 7:00 PM
- *Details to come via School-Day message (still planning and organizing)
    - Same ticket system as last year; 2 tickets per family for each show because of the capacity limit
    - School-Day message will go out this week
    - Previously a cookie was given to a child after the concert, not looking to do that this year
    - No longer held at the church because of the diversity in the school community and some people did not feeling welcome or comfortable in a church
    - Community centre is not big enough to host the concert

- ***-Week of Giving*** - Monday, December 2nd to Friday, December 5th - Ms. Urquhart - messaging going out this week - School-Day message goes out Tuesday!

Monday Dec. 2nd	Tuesday Dec. 3rd	Wednesday Dec. 4th	Thursday Dec. 5th	Friday Dec. 6th
Card and Board Games  Please donate **new** card or board games, crossword puzzles, adult/child colouring books or other activities families can enjoy this holiday season.	**Toiletry Tuesday**  Please send in items like toothbrushes, toothpaste, razors, shampoo, conditioner, deodorant and feminine hygiene products.	**Food Drive**  Please consider bringing in one or two items of non-perishable food for the food bank. ***Items specifically needed include: canned pasta, stews, chili, cold cereal and school snacks.****	**Diapers and Wipes**  Please send in **unopened** boxes or sleeves of diapers and boxes or packages of baby wipes. ***Diaper Sizes 5 & 6 specifically needed***	**Spread the Warmth**  Please donate **new** socks, hats or mittens & gloves. These will help families stay warm over the cold, winter months. ****Teen and Adult Sizes Needed***

- **Action Items:**
  -

---

6. School Improvements

- None discussed.
- **Action Items:**

---

7. Volunteers Update

- New Dundee Volunteer package - Police Check and volunteer package required in order to volunteer. Contact the office for forms or more information
- **Action Items:**

---

8. Principal Fundraising Update

- Mr. Bell started to talk to some staff about the money raised from the Scholastic Book Fair. Some initial ideas include the purchase of books that align with our Safe, Caring & Inclusive Schools (SCIS) initiatives for this year. More specifically, these books would focus on our four key school character traits of: Respect, Integrity, Safety & Encouragement ('RISE'). Books would be in classroom libraries and/or our Literacy Room.
    - Two parents are helping organize the SCIS program: Pam V. and Melissa B.
    - Assembles will start in January to roll out RISE
    - Engage parents and students to read aloud to younger students or cofacilitate assembles
    - First meeting for teachers and parent helpers is in December
- **Action Items:**
    -

---

9. Gardens

- Skipped item for November meeting (butterfly station moved to clubs)
- **Action Items:**

---

10. Grade six transition planning

- Deferred to January agenda

- **Action Items:**

---

11. PD Days and Breaks

- Winter break: December 23 - January 3
- Next PD day is on January 17, 2025
- **Action Items:**

---

12. Nutrition for Learning

- Skip for November meeting, Anita will return in the spring for an update.
- **Action Items:**

---

13. Strong Start

- Not discussed.
- **Action Items:**
    - Follow-up on action item from October: Kelly and Craig still need to reach out to Ms. Ferreira.

---

14. Playground Structure Update

- Not discussed.
- **Action Items:**
    - How much money do we set aside for repairs or replacements a year?

---

15. Class Shuffling Update

- Not discussed.
- **Action Items:**
    - Follow-up on action item from October: For parents to email school chair to ask for more clarity and for shuffling to happen before Sep 30

---

16. Educators Wish List

Musical instruments - Mr. Bell worked with a Long & McQuade representative to source the missing bar for our large xylophone (approximately $100). We chose this route rather than purchasing a small xylophone because we already have small xylophones and we really need a large xylophone.

Mr. Bell met with Nicole Robinson (IEHR - Indigenous, Equity and Human Rights) representative about the two indigenous hand drums that need to be repaired. Nicole

connected Mr. Bell with a gentleman named John Somosi, who is going to repair the drums for approximately $100 per drum.

Discussed potential ceremony at an assembly to utilize the drums and teach the children about Indigenous cultures.

Gym Equipment update
Mr. McKenzie is exploring the purchase of a basketball rack ($800-1000) and plastic goalie hockey sticks ($160-$180). We talked about a small, outdoor basketball net, but we have one and it is rarely used. Pickle ball equipment was addressed, but the ball rack and goalie sticks are a priority; not to mention, space in our small storage room is limited.

Gym storage does not fall under something that school council funds can cover; hence, we are looking to purchase a ball rack instead (for now).

Four square repainting is on hold until the Board does our tarmac (date TBD).

Action Items:

- Sarah Benn motioned to allocate $1,400 for the basketball rack, goalie sticks, xylophone, drums; Melissa Kristensen seconded the motion.
-

17. Financial Report

No financial statement as of right now because some items have not been processed and the statement would not make sense in it's current state. The statement will refresh in the first few days of December and should include the recent fundraisers.Craig will work with Annette to reconcile board report to our records, and Melissa K. and Sarah B. offered to help. The financial report will be ready in January at the latest.

Parent Involvement Funding Grant ($500)
For projects that demonstrate inclusion/outreach to school communities. Examples of expenditures that demonstrate parent engagement, inclusion, equity and/or outreach to school communities may include:

- support of the School Improvement Plan;
- costs related to parent engagement activities in your school;
- translation of posters/literature;
- purchase of parenting books or videos to loan to parents;

- engagement initiatives that support optimizing student learning and achievement;
- meeting costs including honoraria for guest presenters;
- costs related to parent information/orientation sessions;
- costs incurred for workshops supporting student learning and achievement;
- costs related to the development and maintenance of the school websites;
- initiatives that assist special community populations facing access/involvement barriers.

$500 deposited directly into our account and we have to use it otherwise we will lose it.

***We are unable to apply this amount to the year-end staff luncheon**

- **Funds Voted to Spend:** $1,400
- **Pro Grant -** for the community
- $140.80 **in the School Council Float**

Action item:

- January to discuss where PIC funds will go

---

18. Fundraising Plan for 2024/2025

- **Veggie Boxes:** September (Sarah C Update)
    - Sold 129, earning $903
    - Next year, count the boxes as we take them
- **Bookfair**: November
    - Scholastic points are used to purchase items for the school, determined by the staff
    - Went smoothly with kids having a look the day before
    - Some parents said their children did not get the correct change, it is a fast paced environment. We try to encourage parents to send exact change. Children sometimes would share with their friends, lose their money, or go back for bookmarks.
- **Coffee:** December
    - Order due date is November 14
    - Gave them our drink selection (regular coffee, vanilla hazelnut, decaf coffee, peppermint tea, and hot chocolate)

    - Give orders to kids directly instead of parent pick-up
- **Dance-A-Thon:** Friday February 14
    - Scott helps with the equipment
    - NDPS alumni that are in highschool come help
    - Jess and Kelly purchase items to sell and reimbursed afterwards
    - Each group of kids came down for 30 minutes blocks during the middle block of the day, 12pm-2pm
    - Kindergarten classes were brought items to classroom before their dance time
    - Put bracelets on the kids once they left so they could not return and continue purchasing items
- **Chocolate Sales:** March
- **Garden Centre:** April/May

- **Action Items:**
    - Kelly to check if there are items left over from last year and see if Jess would like to help out again this year
    - Kelly and Angie have a karaoke machines
    - Baden Coffee order is ready and we need a cheque. Craig to touchbase with Annette to get a cheque by Dec 3-5 for pick-up.

- **Many hands make light work. Please let us know if you are able to help run any fundraisers.**

---

19. WRAPSC Meeting Update (Angie)

- Letter to be voted on at next WRAPSC to go to MPP's about lack of financial support for EAs and special needs resource consultants
- See if the school adequately addressing bullying awareness, and if staff needs support the school council can help. Not necessary for NDPS as the staff have created a good program.
- **Action Items:**
    -

---

20. Items Added by Council Members

Lunch Program update: Mother Flocker's Chicken (formerly "Turmeric") - Grand Opening (formal opening) was last week

Message from Vanessa Gale, owner of Mother Flocker's:

We are using the exact same recipes as Turmeric Indian Bistro was and the same products. We bought their restaurant which included their recipes and product lists so that we could keep the school lunches the same. We have not changed anything. I hope this helps. In January we will be adding grilled cheese to our menu and the only ingredients will be sliced bread (ie. wonderbread style bread), butter, & kraft cheese slices.

Ingredients List:

-Lemon Garlic Chicken - lemon juice, garlic, vegetable oil, dried parsley, salt & pepper
-**Butter Chicken Poutine** - see recipe above with Fries and poutine curds
-**Fries** - Cavendish fries - link for ingredients https://www.cavendishfarms.com/en/for-your-home/frozen-products/flavourcrisp/crispy-classic-straight-cut/
-**Lentils** - whole black lentils, water, turmeric, Kashmiri mirch, ginger, garlic, onions, fenugreek, cumin, coriander, tomatoes, cilantro, salt, chilli powder, cardamom powder, cloves, cinnamon powder, fennel powder, star anise, bay leaves, black cardamom, & carom seeds
-**Chana Masala** - white chickpeas, water, turmeric, Kashmiri mirch, ginger, garlic, onions, fenugreek, cumin, coriander, tomatoes, cilantro, salt, chilli powder, cardamom powder, cloves, cinnamon powder, fennel powder, star anise, bay leaves, black cardamom, carom seeds & Chana Masala Mix (see ingredients https://mdhspices.com/product/mdh-chana/)
-**Rice** - long grain basmati rice & cumin seeds
-**Chicken Fingers** (Maple Lodge Farms) - Chicken, water, toasted crumbs, wheat flour, wheat gluten, soy protein product, modified corn starch, salt, corn flour, potassium chloride, sodium phosphate, onion powder, baking powder, dried garlic, garlic powder, palm oil, defatted soy flour, spice, guar gum. Browned in vegetable oil.
-Hot Dog Buns - Wonder Hot Dog buns - Enriched Wheat Flour, Water, Sugar, Yeast*, Vegetable Oil, Salt, Wheat Gluten*, Acid, Vegetable Monoglycerides, Ascorbic Acid, Enzymes, May Contain L- Contains: Wheat. May Contain: Soy, Sesame Seeds
-**Hot Dogs** - PC Brand all beef - Beef, Water, Modified Corn Starch, Enriched Wheat Flour,sugars (corn Syrup Solids, Dextrose), Salt, Wheat Gluten, Potassium Lactate, Sodium Phosphate, Spices, Sodium Erythorbate, Garlic Powder,onion Powder, Sodium Diacetate, Sodium Nitrite, Smoke
-**Veggies** - Celery, Cucumbers, Carrots

-Ranch Dip - Kraft Rancher's Choice - https://www.wholesaleclub.ca/salad-dressing-rancher-s-choice/p/20151214_EA
-**Plum Sauce** - https://www.venturafoods.ca/product/sauce-craft-plum-sauce-05460vxc/

Hot Lunch Program Survey

As parents and guardians, you know your children's needs and preferences best. When it comes to hot lunch programs, it's essential that parents and guardians are involved in selecting food options for their children. By giving you the opportunity to provide feedback, we can provide meal options that children are more likely to enjoy, helping them stay energized and focused throughout the day. Your input is invaluable in shaping a program that works for everyone.

School council is gathering information and we would appreciate your feedback. Please take a moment to answer the following questions to help guide the decisions made.

1. **How likely are you to participate in a hot lunch program for your child(ren)?**
    - Very likely
    - Somewhat likely
    - Not likely
2. **How many days a week would you like the hot lunch program to be offered?**
    - 1 time a week
    - 2 times a week
    - 3 times a week
    - I would not participate
3. **What types of meals would your child prefer? (Check all that apply)**
    - Chicken strips
    - Pasta dishes (e.g., butter pasta, spaghetti)
    - Sandwiches/wraps
    - Pizza
    - Salads, fruit (e.g., Caesar, garden salad
    - Other (please specify): _____
4. **Would you like to see healthy snack options included with the meals (e.g., fruit, veggies)?**
    - Yes
    - No
5. **What price range do you feel is reasonable for a hot lunch? (Per meal)**

    - 3$-$5
    - $5–$7
    - $7–$9
    - $9–$12
6. **Would you prefer to see a rotation of different restaurants through the school year or to stick to one provider?**
    - Rotation of different restaurants
    - Stick with the same options in the school year
7. **Are there any specific dietary preferences or restrictions we should consider for your child? (e.g., vegetarian, gluten-free, religious)**
    - Yes (please specify): _____
    - No
8. **Any additional feedback or suggestions regarding the hot lunch program?**

- **Action Items:**
    - January timing of survey
- Here is the link that will show other possible food choices. https://www.esns.ca

---

21. Items Added by Council Members:

- **Action Items:** None

---

22. 2024 / 2025 School Council Dates

- September 16th
- October 21st (7 p.m. - Election/Roles Vote)
- November 25th
- January 27th
- February 24th
- April 21st
- May 26th

- **Action Items:**
- Please email Craig and Angie with any questions and your intent to fill/run for a position on school council. ahallmanrmt@gmail.com and craig_bell@wrdsb.ca
- Here is a link to the handbook School Council Handbook it contains the description of each roll.

---

23. Care Committee:
Dedicated to supporting the well-being of members through acts of kindness, empathy, and practical assistance. The committee's primary goal is to foster a compassionate environment where people feel cared for and supported during times of need, whether due to celebrations or personal challenges. Coordinating gestures: Sending cards, flowers, or small gifts to show care and support during life events and calendar celebrations. Collecting donations from the community is part of this role as it can not be covered by school council funds.

- Kelly Willig - Please provide update on care events
    - Oct 24 ECE appreciation date
    - Card went to Bethel for Nutrition for Learning donation

Action Items:

---

24. Meeting Minutes

- **Moved By:**
- **Seconded By:**

---

25. Agenda Items for next meeting:
Please email the chair or administration with any agenda requests before the next meeting: ndpscouncil@gmail.com & craig_bell@wrdsb.ca